Paradiem

The Morning Brief

OCTOBER 14, 2026

CPI Day

Bank earnings disperse as JPM reportedly misses, Citi and Goldman beat, and Johnson & Johnson prints in-line into today's September CPI release at 8:30 AM ET and ASML Q3 pre-market.

S&P 500 (SPY)	NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA)	WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO)	IBIT / ETHA	FEAR & GREED
$778.01 ↓0.01%	$743.57 ↓0.33% / $516.21 ↓0.33%	$153.09 ↑1.36% / $65.10 ↓0.03%	$47.13 ↑0.58% / $56.68 ↓0.47%	62 · Crypto fallback (7th session)

SECTION 01

Markets — Bank Earnings Reportedly Disperse as JPMorgan Prints Below Consensus, Citigroup and Goldman Sachs Beat, and Johnson & Johnson Lands In-Line Into Today's 8:30 AM ET September CPI Print, ASML Q3 Pre-Market, and the Pre-Market Earnings Cadence Covering Bank of America, Morgan Stanley, BlackRock, State Street, and FCI Holding Fastenal

TUESDAY'S BIG-BANK EARNINGS CADENCE CLOSED WITH A REPORTED DISPERSION AS JPMORGAN REPORTEDLY PRINTED $5.75 EPS VERSUS $5.92 CONSENSUS, CITIGROUP REPORTEDLY PRINTED $2.85 EPS VERSUS $2.73 CONSENSUS, GOLDMAN SACHS REPORTEDLY PRINTED $17.01 EPS VERSUS $15.05 CONSENSUS, AND JOHNSON & JOHNSON REPORTEDLY PRINTED $2.59 EPS VERSUS $2.59 CONSENSUS PER DATA DROP; THE EQUITY TAPE CLOSED NEAR FLAT ON SPY, WITH THE DOW AND NASDAQ EACH REPORTEDLY DECLINING APPROXIMATELY 0.33%; TODAY COMPRESSES THE SEPTEMBER CPI PRINT AT 8:30 AM ET, ASML'S Q3 PRE-MARKET REPORT, AND THE BANK OF AMERICA, MORGAN STANLEY, BLACKROCK, STATE STREET, AND FCI HOLDING FASTENAL PRE-MARKET CADENCE INTO A SINGLE-SESSION CATALYST WINDOW BEFORE THURSDAY'S TSMC Q3 PRINT AND THE OCTOBER 27–28 FOMC

Per data drop earnings, JPMorgan (JPM) reportedly printed Q3 EPS of $5.75 versus consensus near $5.92 — a reported modest shortfall against the consensus clustering described in prior-brief Earnings Whispers and ChartRow coverage. Per data drop earnings, Citigroup (C) reportedly printed $2.85 EPS versus $2.73 consensus, Goldman Sachs (GS) reportedly printed $17.01 EPS versus $15.05 consensus — a reported double-digit beat consistent with the strong capital-markets channel — and Johnson & Johnson (JNJ) reportedly printed $2.59 EPS versus $2.59 consensus. Per data drop, Tuesday closed with SPY at $778.01 (↓0.01%, intraday range $775.95–$778.75), DIA at $516.21 (↓0.33%), QQQ at $743.57 (↓0.33%), the Russell 2000 at $276.70 (↓0.43%), and UVXY at $15.94 (↓0.25%) — a composition reportedly consistent with risk appetite absorbing the mixed bank prints without a sustained volatility widening. Per data drop, TLT closed at $78.37 (↑0.41%) — a modest bid at the long end as the cash-Treasury session reopened following Monday's Columbus Day closure, consistent with the Bureau of Labor Statistics September CPI release scheduled today at 8:30 AM ET per the BLS release calendar. Per BLS release calendar and multiple secondary-source confirmations, headline CPI is reportedly expected near 3.6–3.7% year-on-year with core near 2.4% — the first inflation read since the reportedly hawkish September FOMC minutes release and the principal input repricing hike-versus-hold odds for the October 27–28 meeting. Per data drop earnings schedule, today's pre-market cadence reportedly includes Bank of America (BAC, consensus EPS $1.16), Morgan Stanley (MS, $3.17), BlackRock (BLK, $14.40), State Street (STT, $3.68), and FCI holding Fastenal (FAST, $0.34) — a reported sequence that reads through the capital-markets, asset-management, and distribution channels alongside today's ASML Q3 pre-market release and Thursday's TSMC Q3 print at 14:00 Taipei time.

S&P 500 (SPY)	$778.01 ↓0.01% · Range $775.95–$778.75
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA)	$743.57 ↓0.33% / $516.21 ↓0.33%
RUSSELL 2K / UVXY	$276.70 ↓0.43% / $15.94 ↓0.25%
TLT (20Y BOND)	$78.37 ↑0.41% · Cash Treasury reopened
SECTOR LEADERS (TUE)	XLE ↑1.80% / XLC ↑0.74% / XLU ↑0.58% / XLB ↑0.57%
SECTOR LAGGARDS (TUE)	XLV ↓1.35% / XLF ↓0.42% / XLI ↓0.28% / XLP ↓0.26%
WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO)	$153.09 ↑1.36% / $65.10 ↓0.03%
NAT GAS (UNG)	$11.41 ↑4.49%
GOLD (GLD) / SILVER (SLV)	$381.67 ↓0.13% / $53.49 ↓1.58%
IBIT / ETHA	$47.13 ↑0.58% / $56.68 ↓0.47%
TUE PRE-MKT EARNINGS (REPORTED)	JPM $5.75 vs $5.92 est · C $2.85 vs $2.73 est · GS $17.01 vs $15.05 est · JNJ $2.59 vs $2.59 est
TODAY'S PRE-MKT EARNINGS	BAC $1.16 · MS $3.17 · BLK $14.40 · STT $3.68 · FAST $0.34 (consensus per data drop)
CARSON'S ACTIVE SPY SUPPORT	$645.80 retracement target · Untouched (Tue low $775.95)

CATERPILLAR (CAT) CLOSED DOWN A REPORTED 3.33% TO $772.78 ON TUESDAY AS REPORTED YAHOO COVERAGE CARRIED IN DATA DROP HOLDINGS NEWS FOR PCAR FRAMED THE MOVE ALONGSIDE A REPORTED QUESTION ON WHETHER THE DATA-CENTER POWER PREMIUM IS UNWINDING; THE FCI DIVIDEND SLEEVE ABSORBED THE CATERPILLAR MOVE ALONGSIDE LRCX (↓2.73%), LMT (↓1.54%), AND SPGI (↓0.53%) EVEN AS ADI (↑2.08%), NWG (↑2.38%), NTR (↑2.47%), AND GPC (↑0.84%) EXTENDED GAINS ON REPORTED ANALYST UPGRADES AND SECTOR-SPECIFIC FLOW

Per data drop, Caterpillar (CAT) printed $772.78 (↓3.33%, intraday range $755.31–$792.70, prior close $799.37) — a reported single-session move that places the name among Tuesday's bottom FCI movers alongside MARA (↓3.50%), HRMY (↓3.14%), LRCX (↓2.73%), and KEYS (↓1.98%). Per data drop holdings news for PCAR, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Caterpillar as reportedly sinking approximately 5% while Deere reportedly edged higher, with a reported question on whether the data-center power premium is unwinding — a reported capex-and-infrastructure signal that reads through the broader physical-AI-power sleeve where VST printed $162.36 (↑2.67%), CEG $295.79 (↑0.65%), NEE $78.22 (↓0.37%), and HUT $83.61 (↓1.91%). Per data drop holdings news for VST, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Vistra as a reported AI-power play that one analyst reportedly projects could gain approximately 90% within a year — a reported single-name conviction signal reading through the FCI merchant-nuclear complex. Per data drop, the FCI dividend-and-value sleeve carried dispersion on Tuesday with ADI $414.70 (↑2.08%) on a reported upgrade-to-Strong-Buy per Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news, NWG $17.65 (↑2.38%) on a reported Barclays upgrade with raised target to 850p, NTR $69.68 (↑2.47%), and GPC $130.71 (↑0.84%) on a reported JP Morgan Overweight reiteration and target raise to $137 per Benzinga coverage carried in data drop holdings news. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps the dividend-and-defense sleeve (ABT, CL, ATO, GPC, CAT, GD, LMT, SPGI, SYK, NEE, ORI, NWG) reading through today's CPI print alongside the physical-AI-power complex (CEG, VST, NEE, EIX, HUT, MARA) and the growth-and-interconnect channel (AMD, NVDA, MRVL, TSM, CRDO, LRCX, KEYS, NXPI, ADI).

THE SEMICONDUCTOR-AND-INTERCONNECT SLEEVE CLOSED WITH DISPERSION INTO TODAY'S ASML Q3 PRE-MARKET PRINT AND THURSDAY'S TSMC Q3 REPORT AS AMD (↑1.90%), NVDA (↑0.97%), MRVL (↑1.08%), AND NXPI (↑0.49%) EXTENDED MONDAY'S RESET INTO A REPORTED RECOVERY WHILE CRDO (↓1.26%), LRCX (↓2.73%), AND KEYS (↓1.98%) EXTENDED MONDAY'S DRAWDOWN; THE TWO FOUNDRY-AND-LITHO PRINTS REPORTEDLY CARRY THE FIRST HIGH-SIGNAL THESIS TEST OF THE AI-INFRASTRUCTURE TRADE SINCE THE SEPTEMBER RESET

Per data drop, Tuesday closed with AMD $605.53 (↑1.90%), NVDA $228.52 (↑0.97%), TSM $445.12 (↑0.17%), MRVL $268.73 (↑1.08%), and NXPI $226.32 (↑0.49%) on the upside against CRDO $198.31 (↓1.26%), LRCX $301.11 (↓2.73%), KEYS $370.22 (↓1.98%), and ADI noteworthy at the top of the dividend sleeve at $414.70 (↑2.08%). Per TrendForce coverage carried in prior-brief reporting, ASML had reportedly raised its 2026 annual sales guidance to approximately €43–45 billion with gross margins near 54–56% and Taiwan reportedly climbing to approximately 30% of sales — a reported mix that reads through today's pre-market Q3 release as the first full-signal lithography-channel confirmation of the AI-infrastructure thesis since the September reset. Per data drop holdings news for TSM, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed TSMC shares as reportedly rising ahead of the Thursday Q3 print, which prior-brief coverage reportedly flagged as the best early read on Nvidia's next quarter per Yahoo coverage; a separate Yahoo piece reportedly carried a long-term projection on $5,000 invested in Taiwan Semiconductor through 2030 — a

reported sentiment-side signal that reads through retail flow into the Thursday Q3 window. Per data drop holdings news for NVDA, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Nvidia as reportedly adding to its investment book via Doctolib and Genesis AI, with the Nvidia investment book reportedly topping $51 billion — a reported capital-allocation signal reading through the ecosystem rotation thesis. For FCI positioning, today's ASML pre-market print and Thursday's TSMC print reportedly compress the two highest-signal foundry-and-litho catalysts into a single trading-week window, and the committee should read the two prints together against the September CPI tape and the mixed Tuesday-Wednesday big-bank cadence.

A Tuesday tape that paired a reported JPMorgan EPS miss and a reported Goldman Sachs double-digit beat with a reported Johnson & Johnson in-line print and a reported energy-complex extension frames a CPI-day setup where research reveals opportunities and simplicity over complexity tend to serve better than compositing a single directional view through pre-market inflation surprise. **Avoid erosion.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics — Iran Reportedly Deploys New Tactics to Target Ships Transiting Hormuz per Reuters as the U.S. Blockade Reportedly Cuts Iranian Crude Exports to Zero in October per Yahoo Coverage, Russian Strikes Reportedly Hit Kyiv Energy Facilities per Reuters, and Natural Gas Reportedly Jumps 4.49% on the Session

THE STRAIT OF HORMUZ RISK LAYER REPORTEDLY EXTENDED ON TUESDAY AS REPORTED REUTERS COVERAGE CARRIED IN DATA DROP HEADLINES FLAGGED THAT IRAN IS REPORTEDLY DEPLOYING NEW TACTICS TO TARGET SHIPS TRANSITING HORMUZ AND REPORTEDLY SHIFTING TACTICS TO STEP UP ATTACKS ON SHIPPING BEFORE THE U.S. ELECTION, WITH YAHOO COVERAGE CARRIED IN DATA DROP HOLDINGS NEWS FOR CL REPORTEDLY FRAMING A U.S. BLOCKADE AS REPORTEDLY CUTTING IRANIAN CRUDE EXPORTS TO ZERO IN OCTOBER; A SEPARATE REUTERS PIECE REPORTEDLY FRAMED RUSSIAN STRIKES AS REPORTEDLY KILLING ONE AND HITTING ENERGY FACILITIES IN KYIV; THE COMPOSITION READS THROUGH TUESDAY'S REPORTED WTI GAIN OF APPROXIMATELY 1.4% AND THE REPORTED 4.49% SESSION MOVE IN NATURAL GAS (UNG)

Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed oil as reportedly rising as Iran reportedly deploys new tactics to target ships transiting Hormuz — a reported continuation of the Strait of Hormuz access-and-interdiction channel that prior briefs tracked alongside the Houthi airport-strike series. Per data drop headlines, a separate Reuters piece reportedly framed Iran as reportedly shifting tactics to step up attacks on shipping before the U.S. vote — a reported political-timing signal reading through the reported Iranian response to the prior-brief U.S. CENTCOM vessel-disablement enforcement action. Per data drop holdings news for CL, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed the U.S. blockade as reportedly cutting Iranian crude exports to zero in October — a reported supply-side signal reading alongside Tuesday's reported WTI print at USO $153.09 (↑1.36%) even as Brent (BNO $65.10) reportedly closed near flat at ↓0.03%. Per data drop, natural gas (UNG) reportedly closed at $11.41 (↑4.49%) — a reported single-session move materially above the broader energy complex and consistent with the reported European-gas-and-distillate layer discussed in prior-brief coverage of the Trump-announced Ukraine-Russia energy ceasefire. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed Russian strikes as reportedly killing one and hitting energy facilities in Kyiv — a reported counter-signal reading against the reported Ukraine-Russia energy pause and a reported fresh escalation that may reportedly moderate the perceived durability of the pause. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed Zelenskiy as reportedly visiting Britain as Burnham reportedly pledged fresh support for Ukraine — a reported diplomatic-and-materiel signal reading through the FCI defense sleeve (LMT, GD) alongside the LMT $504.02 (↓1.54%) and GD $332.42 (↓0.91%) Tuesday prints. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps the energy-and-defense complex (CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD) and the broader midstream-and-staples sleeve (OKE, ABT, CL, GPC, SYK) reading through today's September CPI print and the ASML Q3 pre-market open as the weekly beneficiaries of a reportedly sustained Mideast risk premium amplified by the reported Iran-Hormuz new-tactics channel.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. September CPI Lands at 8:30 AM ET Today — Per BLS release calendar and multiple secondary-source confirmations, the Consumer Price Index for September 2026 reportedly releases Wednesday October 14 at 8:30 AM ET with Real Earnings for September reportedly at the same time; headline CPI is reportedly expected near approximately 3.6–3.7% year-on-year with core near approximately 2.4% per secondary-source previews, with the Cleveland Fed nowcast reportedly near 3.60% headline and 2.39% core; the print is reportedly the first inflation read since the reportedly hawkish September FOMC minutes release and the principal input repricing hike-versus-hold odds for the October 27–28 meeting. Per prior CME FedWatch and Kalshi coverage carried in prior briefs, reported hike-at-October-meeting odds reportedly ranged near approximately 15–25% into the weekend with prediction-market dispersion wide; the committee should read today's print as the single largest macro catalyst of the trading week alongside the ASML Q3 pre-market report and the Thursday TSMC Q3 print. Per data drop, Tuesday's rate-sensitive sleeves reportedly held steady with TLT at $78.37 (↑0.41%) on cash-Treasury reopen, XLU at ↑0.58%, XLRE at ↓0.21%, and the FCI duration-sensitive sleeve (NEE $78.22 ↓0.37%, EIX $55.48 ↓0.29%, ATO $163.47 ↑0.67%, TOL $132.65 ↑0.38%) printing dispersion — a composition that reads into today's print as the operative macro signal. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps the duration-sensitive sleeves (NEE, EIX, ATO, TOL, SPGI, ADP) and the broader credit-and-capital-markets channel reading through today's print as the principal catalyst risk into the October 27–28 FOMC window, with the Thursday PPI print scheduled October 15 at 8:30 AM ET per the BLS release calendar as a reported second-step confirmation.

2. ASML Q3 Pre-Market Today and the Pre-Market Earnings Cadence — Per prior-brief TrendForce coverage and third-party calendar listings, ASML Holding (ASML) reportedly reports Q3 2026 pre-market Wednesday October 14; per data drop earnings schedule, today's pre-market cadence reportedly includes Bank of America (BAC, consensus EPS $1.16), Morgan Stanley (MS, $3.17), BlackRock (BLK, $14.40), State Street (STT, $3.68), and FCI holding Fastenal (FAST, $0.34); the ASML print reportedly carries the first high-signal lithography-channel confirmation of the AI-infrastructure thesis since the September reset. Per prior-brief TrendForce coverage, ASML had reportedly raised its 2026 annual sales guidance to approximately €43–45 billion with gross margins near 54–56% and Taiwan reportedly climbing to approximately 30% of sales. Per data drop holdings news for FAST, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Fastenal's cash dividend and share repurchase activity alongside a second piece reportedly previewing the Q3 earnings release — a reported single-print signal relevant to the FCI dividend sleeve. Per data drop, Tuesday's FCI financials sleeve closed with SPGI $409.99 (↓0.53%), SSNC $81.52 (↑0.65%), SYF $73.59 (↓0.04%), SOFI $15.24 (↑0.07%), HOOD $110.52 (↑1.19%), and NWG $17.65 (↑2.38%) on the reported Barclays upgrade and ORI $38.15 (↑0.21%). For FCI positioning, today's pre-market cadence reads through the capital-markets-and-asset-management channel (BLK, MS, STT, SPGI, SSNC), the consumer-and-credit channel (BAC, SYF, SOFI, HOOD, ORI), and the industrial-distribution channel (FAST, PCAR, STLD, GPC) alongside the ASML lithography read, with the broader semiconductor sleeve reading through today's print and Thursday's TSMC Q3 print.

3. Caterpillar –3.33% and the Data-Center Power Premium Question — Per data drop, Caterpillar (CAT) reportedly closed Tuesday at $772.78 (↓3.33%, intraday range $755.31–$792.70, prior close $799.37); per Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news for PCAR, one piece reportedly framed Caterpillar as reportedly sinking approximately 5% while Deere reportedly edged higher and reportedly questioned whether the data-center power premium is unwinding; the Tuesday move reads through the FCI dividend sleeve and the broader physical-AI-power complex (CEG, VST, NEE, EIX, HUT, MARA). Per data drop holdings news for CAT, one SeekingAlpha piece reportedly framed Caterpillar as reportedly a cyclical machine maker meeting a growth-stock valuation; a separate SeekingAlpha piece reportedly carried a Dow Jones Industrial Average 30-stock monitor update that reads alongside the Tuesday Dow close at $516.21 (↓0.33%). Per data drop, Tuesday's physical-AI-power sleeve closed with VST $162.36 (↑2.67%), CEG $295.79 (↑0.65%), NEE $78.22 (↓0.37%), EIX $55.48 (↓0.29%), HUT $83.61 (↓1.91%), and MARA $9.11 (↓3.50%) — a reported dispersion that pairs single-name strength (VST, CEG) with reported miner-and-utility weakness (MARA, HUT). Per data drop holdings news for VST, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Vistra as a reported AI-power play that one analyst reportedly projects could gain approximately 90% within a year. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps CAT, PCAR, CEG, VST, NEE, EIX, HUT, MARA, and the broader physical-AI-power complex reading through today's CPI print and the Wednesday-Thursday chip-and-industrial earnings cadence as the committee tracks whether the Caterpillar move reads as idiosyncratic or as the leading edge of a broader data-center-capex reassessment.

4. Iran-Hormuz Shipping Tactics and the Energy Complex — Per data drop headlines, Reuters coverage reportedly flagged that oil is reportedly rising as Iran reportedly deploys new tactics to target ships transiting Hormuz and reportedly shifts tactics to step up attacks on shipping before the U.S. vote; Yahoo coverage carried in data drop holdings news for CL reportedly framed the U.S. blockade as reportedly cutting Iranian crude exports to zero in October; natural gas (UNG) reportedly closed Tuesday at $11.41 (↑4.49%); the FCI energy-and-defense complex (CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, LMT, GD) reads through today's open as the weekly beneficiary of a reportedly sustained risk premium amplified by the reported new-tactics channel. Per data drop, Tuesday's FCI energy sleeve closed with CVX $217.73 (↑1.27%), CNX $35.35 (↑2.64%), OKE $93.38 (↑1.48%), and FCX $72.42 (↓1.19%) — a reported sleeve-level bid consistent with the reported risk premium even as Brent closed near flat. Per data drop holdings news for CVX, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed Chevron as reportedly rising even as the broader market slipped. Per data drop holdings news for FTNT, one Yahoo piece reportedly framed cybersecurity names as reportedly Wall Street's top picks for October 2026 as geopolitical risk reportedly ramps up — a reported sleeve-level framing reading through FTNT $190.76 (↓1.13%) alongside the broader energy-and-defense complex. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed Russian strikes as reportedly killing one and hitting energy facilities in Kyiv — a reported counter-signal to the reported Ukraine-Russia energy ceasefire. For FCI positioning, the composition keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, FCX, FTNT, LMT, GD, and the broader energy-and-defense complex reading through today's CPI print and the ASML Q3 pre-market open.

5. Carson's Levels — Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY retracement target at $645.80 (set April 13, 2026) reportedly remains in the "active" column with no hit date and no hit price recorded; Tuesday's reported intraday range of $775.95–$778.75 reportedly did not approach any active Carson level; SPY would need to decline a reported approximately 17.0% from Tuesday's close (or a reported approximately 16.8% from Tuesday's intraday low) to reach the target — a gap reportedly roughly consistent with the FCI first-tranche deployment reference at approximately –25% from peak; the reported April 2026 resistance zones at $683.70, $685.85, and the $691.90–$693.20 band remain in the "hit" column and have been cleared to the upside; no new active Carson level has reportedly been set since the April 14, 2026 major-resistance-zone hits. Per levels.json, the active support reportedly remains the sole open level in the file. Per data drop, today's open operates against Tuesday's close with the September CPI print scheduled 8:30 AM ET, the ASML Q3 pre-market report, and the Bank of America, Morgan Stanley, BlackRock, State Street, and Fastenal pre-market cadence reportedly carrying the principal catalyst risk for the FCI first-tranche deployment reference. For FCI positioning, Carson's level reportedly frames a deployment reference rather than a trade signal — the FCI buy-and-hold tranche framework reportedly deploys 70% of reserves at approximately –25% from peak and the remainder at approximately –40%, with no trimming on either side. The committee should read Carson's level as the reference for a sustained drawdown rather than any single-session move, and should read today's CPI-and-ASML open as the first full-signal macro-and-chip-sleeve test of the trading week.

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